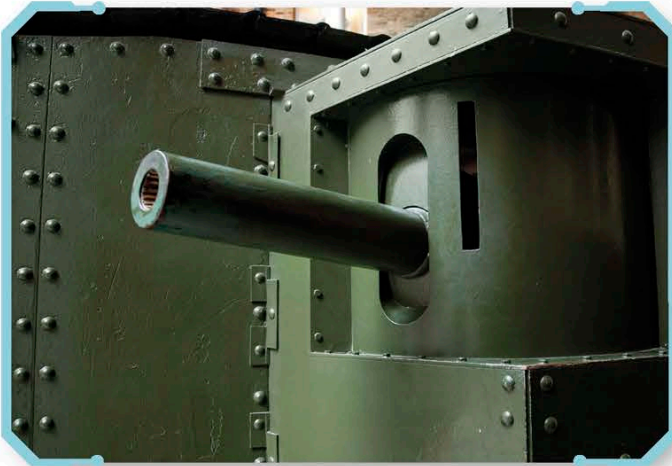


MIGHTY MACHINES

German troops must have been terrified at the sight of a Mark IV tank rumbling toward them, especially as their rifle bullets often pinged off its armor as it slowly but unstoppably approached, its powerful guns blasting. But the Mark IV is not invincible. Thick mud and steep slopes cause it as much trouble as German missiles, and being inside one is a hot, sweaty, uncomfortable, and dangerous experience.



Six-pounder gun

There were two types of Mark IV tank. One had a large gun on each side that fired six-pound shells. The other had two machine guns on each side instead, making it useful in close combat against infantry troops.

The roof had one entrance hatch for eight crew members: a driver, commander, two side gunners, two loaders, and two brake operators.

The tank's 105 hp (horse power) Daimler engine could reach a top speed of just 3.69 mph (5.95 km/h).

The bulge on the tank's side was called a sponson. It allowed the gun to rotate and find its target more easily.

"It was a **complete and utter surprise** to the Germans that we **ever devised** such a thing as a **tank**."

—Monty Cleeve, British artillery officer (1894-1993)



Heavy ammunition

Mark IV tanks carried around 300 shells for their six-pounder guns. They could be fired a distance of more than 4¼ miles (7 km) and each one was 19 in (48 cm) long and 3 in (7.6 cm) in diameter.

The Mark IV's armor was ½ in (12 mm) thick. This made it bulletproof, but heavy artillery fire could stop it in its tracks.

